

Def. Let V be a vector space.

Given a vector $\alpha \in V$ and linear operation $T: V \rightarrow V$, the subspace

$$Z(\alpha, T) \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \{g(T)\alpha \mid g(t) \in F[t]\} = \text{span}\{T^k \alpha \mid k \in \mathbb{N} \cup \{0\}\}.$$

is called the T -cyclic subspace generated by α

Def. Let V be a vector space. Given $\alpha \in V$ and a linear operator T on V , an ideal

$$M(\alpha, T) = \{g(t) \in F[t] \mid g(T)\alpha = 0\}$$

is called the T -annihilator of α , and the unique monic generator of it also called μ .

Thm. Let α be any non-zero vector in V and let p_α be the T -annihilator of α .

- 1) $\deg p_\alpha = \dim Z(\alpha, T)$
- 2) $Z(\alpha, T) = \text{span}\{T^k \alpha \mid 0 \leq k \leq \deg p_\alpha\}$
- 3) The minimal polynomial of $T|_{Z(\alpha, T)}$ is p_α .